



Steaming past Vicksburg

On the night of April 16–17, Admiral Porter led 12 Union gunboats and transports south past Vicksburg, to carry supplies to the point where Grant planned to cross the river. Only one Union vessel was lost.

Confederate confusion

In a matter of days, Grant's boldness had shattered Pemberton's confidence. His titular theater commander, Joseph E. Johnston, was also surprised. Both had supposed that Johnston would have several months to assemble an army, which, combined with Pemberton's 35,000 men, would allow them to attack on numerically equal terms at a time and point of their choosing. Grant had deprived them of that opportunity and was moving to strike them in detail (systematically). Pemberton thought he was the likely first target, as Grant's easy option would have been to march due north, up the river, with his flank guarded by Porter's fleet. Instead, Grant moved to the east away from Vicksburg.